

Hz Uthman ^{RA}

Name

Uthman

ibn Affan

ibn Abi al-As

ibn Umayyah

ibn Abd Shams

ibn Abd Manaf

Meets the prophet ^{SAW} in 5 generations

Tribe

- Tribe: **Banu Umayyah**
- Father: **Affan ibn Abi al-As**. A wealthy merchant from Ummayyd clan who passed away before the advent of Islam at a young age, leaving Hz Uthman RA a large inheritance.
- Mother: **Arwa bint Kurayz**
- Kunyah: Abu Abdullah and Abu Laylah
- Later known as Dhun-Noorayn (Owner of the Two Lights)

AGE

6 years
younger than
the Prophet ^{SAW}

KNOWLEDGE

One of the few Makkans
literate in both reading and
writing from a young age

PROFESSION

A highly successful
merchant and
businessman

STATUS

Held in the highest
esteem by the
Makkans for his lofty
morals and noble
character

CHARACTER

From the Jāhiliyyah period, he was noted for:

- Exceptional modesty and humility despite great wealth and high social rank
- Generosity toward the poor and needy, spent freely on those in need
- Soft nature and kind heart
- Never wronged anyone, never engaged in obscenity, never prostrated to idols

AS A SCHOLAR

- A Hafiz of the Quran
- Scribe of Waḥy, beautiful handwriting
Deeply knowledgeable in Asbab al-Nuzul
- Well-qualified in fiqh; his verdicts appear in books of Islamic jurisprudence
- Recognized authority on the laws of Ḥajj, even Hz Umar ^{RA} consulted him on this

His Physical Appearance

- Slightly above average height
- Extremely handsome, Abdur-Rahmān ibn Ḥazm al-Muzanyy is reported to have said:
"I never saw a man or woman handsomer of face than him"
- Fair-skinned with a touch of redness in his face
- Broad-shouldered, large-jointed
- Thick beard, dyed yellow
- Long hair reaching his shoulders
- Gold-braced teeth

Ahadith on Virtues

- Hz Ayesha ^{RA} narrates: The Prophet ^{SAW} was resting in her apartment with his legs exposed. Abu Bakr came in the Prophet did not adjust himself. Umar came, the Prophet did not adjust. When Uthman arrived, the Prophet ^{SAW} sat up and straightened his clothing. When asked, the Prophet ^{SAW} said: "Should I not be bashful of a man in whose presence even the angels feel bashful?" (Muslim)
- "Uthman is the most of my Companions in resembling my character" (Ibn Asakir)
- "If I had forty daughters, I would give them in marriage to you one by one until none remained" (Ibn Asakir)
- "The most compassionate of my nation is Abu Bakr; the firmest in Allah's Law is Umar; the most bashful is Uthman" (Tirmidhi, Nasā'ī, Ibn Mājah)
- "The Angels feel bashful of Uthman the way they feel bashful of Allah and His Messenger" (Ibn Abī Ya' lā)
- "Uthman passed by me when an angel was sitting with me. The angel exclaimed, 'A martyr whose people will kill! We feel bashful of him!'" (Ibn Asakir)

Ahadith on Virtues

- I was once sitting with the Prophet ^{SAW} in one of the wells of Medina. And a man came and knocked on the door of the garden. So, the Prophet^{SAW} said, "Go and open the door for him and give him glad tidings of Jannah." I went and opened the door and it was Abu Bakr and I gave him glad tidings of Jannah and he said alhamdulillah and he came and sat with us. Then after a while another knock came. So, the Prophet^{SAW} said, "Go and open the door and give him glad tidings of Jannah." The same story with Umar ibn al-Khattab and he comes and sits down. Then the third knock. And the Prophet ^{SAW} says, "Go and tell him that he shall enter Jannah after a calamity befalls him." (Bukhari and Muslim)

Dhun-Noorayn: The Owner of Two Lights

- Hz Uthman ^{RA} is the only man known to have married two daughters of a Prophet
- **First marriage:** Ruqayyah bint Muḥammad ^{SAW}
 - Previously betrothed to Utbah ibn Abu Lahab (divorced when Abu Lahab opposed Islam)
 - Hz Uthman ^{RA} rushed to ask for her hand; the Prophet ^{SAW} gave her in marriage
 - She fell ill before the Battle of Badr; Hz Uthman ^{RA} stayed behind to care for her
 - She passed away as the news of Badr's victory arrived
- **Second marriage:** Umm Kulthum bint Muḥammad ^{SAW}
 - Previously married to Utaybah ibn Abu Lahab
 - The Prophet ^{SAW} offered her hand to console ʿUthmān in his grief
 - She lived with him until she passed away in the 9th year AH

Embracing Islam

- Among the earliest converts, accepted Islam at age 34
- His maternal aunt, Sauda bint Kurayz, had already foretold the coming of a Prophet
- On his way home from a trade trip to Syria (while falling sleep), Uthman heard a voice calling out: "O sleepers, arise, for Ahmad has emerged in Mecca." This vision prepared his heart before he even reached Makkah.
- He and Abu Bakr ^{RA} were close friends and he invited him to Islam
- After speaking with Abu Bakr, Uthman went directly to the Prophet ^{SAW}
- The Prophet ^{SAW} said to him upon seeing him: "Respond to Allah's call, O Uthman, for I am Allah's Messenger to you in particular and to all people in general."
- Hz Uthmān ^{RA} narrates: "By Allah, no sooner had I looked at him and listened to his words than he became the apple of my eye and found his way quickly to my heart."
- He immediately pronounced the Shahādah
- The Quraysh who once loved Uthman ^{RA} became his enemies

During the life of the Prophet ^{SAW}

- **The Two Hijrahs:** One of very few Companions to make both the Hijrah to Abyssinia and to Madinah, accompanied by his wife Ruqayyah ^{RA} each time
- **Scribe of Revelation:** Appointed by the Prophet ^{SAW} as a Katib al-Wahy due to his exceptionally beautiful handwriting
- **Role in Battles:** Excused from Badr to nurse Ruqayyah (given full reward); participated in Uhud and Khandaq
- **Hudaybiyyah & Bay'at al-Ridwan:** Sent as the Prophet's ^{SAW} personal envoy to Quraysh; when rumor spread of his death, the Prophet ^{SAW} placed his own hand saying "This is on behalf of Uthman" one of the greatest honors given to any Companion
- **Financial Contributions:** Purchased and donated the well of Roomah; expanded Masjid al-Nabawi; single-handedly equipped one-third of the Tabuk army

On the death of Hz Umer ^{RA}

- When asked to name a successor, Hz Umar ^{RA} refused to name one directly
- He mentioned Hz Abu Ubaydah ibn al-Jarrah^{RA} and Hz Salim ^{RA} (both had passed away)
- He refused to appoint his son Abdullah: "It is enough to have one of this household held accountable"
- He appointed a Shura of six from the Asharah al-Mubashsharah
 - Hz Ali Ibn Abi Talib^{RA}, Hz Uthman ibn Affan^{RA}, Hz Abdurrehman ibn Auf ^{RA}, Hz Sa'd ibn Abi Waqas ^{RA}, Hz Zubayr ibn al-awam ^{RA}, Hz Talha ibn 'Ubaydullah ^{RA}
 - Hz Abdullāh ibn Umar ^{RA} attended as observer (no voting right)
- Said the shura had 3 days to decide. Anyone who then disagrees, he is the rebel, fight him and kill him
- Said Suhaib al-Rumi will lead the salah for those 3 days. Because he wanted to appoint somebody neutral. It wouldn't make sense to appoint one of the six to lead the prayer because that would be preference to one

Consultation of Shura

- As Hz Umer ^{RA} passes away, the six of them gather together.
- Hz Abdur Rahman ibn Auf ^{RA} says, Let three of you withdraw and nominate one person in his stead
- Hz Zubair ibn al-Awwam ^{RA} nominated Hz Ali^{RA}
Hz Talha ^{RA} gave his right to Hz Uthman ^{RA}
Hz Sa'd ibn Abi Waqqas ^{RA} gave it to Abdur Rahman ^{RA}
- Now you have Uthman ^{RA}, Ali ^{RA} and Abdurrehman ^{RA}
- Hz Abdurrehman ^{RA} says I don't want it. Who of you two is willing to recede your right.
- Both of them stayed silent
- Hz Abdurrehman bin Auf ^{RA} offered to decide between them based on opinion of other sahaba and people in general, to which they both agreed
- After detailed discussions and consultations with a number of sahaba for the next three days he chose Hz Uthman ^{RA}.

The Bay'ah & Hz Uthman assumes the caliphate

- Hz Uthman ^{RA} received the pledge of allegiance while standing on the pulpit of the Prophet ^{SAW}
- His caliphate officially began: Muḥarram, 24 AH (644 CE)
- He was approximately 70 years old when he assumed office

Key Points in his first Address as Caliph

- "We all live in an ephemeral world as passers-by, make the best use of your lives"
- "Do not let this worldly present life deceive you, nor let Satan lead you astray"
- "Learn a lesson from those who came before you"
- "Where are all the people who lived and led luxurious lives? Their lives came to an end"
- Quoted Surat al-Kahf (18:45–46): the parable of worldly life as rain....vegetation grows, then withers; only righteous deeds endure
- His address contained no political agenda, it was a call to piety, asceticism, and remembrance of Allah

The Inherited Empire

- Took charge of the largest Muslim state yet, stretching from Persia to North Africa
- Inheriting an empire at the peak of its territorial expansion, Hz Usman ^{RA} faced the mounting pressures of governance, tribal rivalries, and provincial unrest that were ultimately weaponized against him.
- His 12-year caliphate (23–35 AH) is divided into two halves: the first six years of peace and expansion, the second six of growing trial
- The Prophet ^{SAW} foretold both his caliphate and his martyrdom
"Perhaps Allah will clothe you with a garment (i.e. the caliphate), and if the people want you to remove it, do not remove it." (Tirmidhi)

The First Case Before him

- Before Hz Usman ^{RA} could settle in, he faced an immediate and delicate legal crisis
- Ubaydullāh ibn Umar had killed Abu Lu'lu'ah's daughter, an innocent girl, in rage over his father assassination
- Hz Alī ^{RA} suggested that he should be killed. Some Muhajireen also suggested the same.
- Hz Usman ^{RA} declared himself the wali of those killed and paid blood money from his own pocket, preventing further bloodshed. **Hadith:** The Sultan is the wali of one who has no wali" (Abu Dawud, Tirmidhi)
- This single act displayed extraordinary wisdom: he absorbed personal cost to preserve communal peace

Kufah: The Volatile Province

- Hz Usman ^{RA} initially appointed Hz Sa'd ibn Abi Waqqās ^{RA} as governor of Kufah, continuing Hz Umar's policy
- Hz Sa'd ^{RA} was removed due to a financial dispute
- Hz Uthman replaced him with **Hz Walīd ibn Uqbah** ^{RA}, who governed for five years before being accused of consuming alcohol; Hz Usman ^{RA} had him punished with forty lashes on the verdict of Hz Ali ^{RA}
- He then appointed **Hz Saed ibn Al As** ^{RA}, who faced relentless agitation from people of Kufa
- Eventually, at the people's insistence, Hz Uthman appointed **Hz Abu Musa al-Ashari** ^{RA} writing to the Kufans: "I have appointed someone over you who you prefer... I will give in to whatever you request provided it does not entail disobedience to Allah"

Azerbaijan & Armenia - Rebellion Suppressed (26 AH)

- Azerbaijan and Armenia had been conquered under Hz Umer ^{RA}
- A rebellion arose after Hz Umar's death
- Hz Usman ^{RA} ordered Hz Walid Ibn Uqbah ^{RA}, governor of Kufah, to crush it. Walid ibn Uqbah sent Salman ibn Rabi from Kufa's direction, coming at Armenia from the east and south with 8,000 soldiers.
- Hz Muawiyah^{RA} sent his army from Syria, coming at Armenia from the west, simultaneously engaging the Byzantine force under Constans II that had likely moved to support or exploit the Armenian rebellion
- By end of 26 AH: the entire region up to the Caucasus Mountains came under Islam

The Death of the Last Persian King

- The End of the Sassanid Empire
- It was during Hz Usman ^{RA} caliphate that Yazdajird, the last Persian king, was killed
- He had hoped to fall into Arab Muslim hands, expecting mercy
- After years of fleeing eastward through his crumbling empire, Yazdegerd III ended up near Merv(a great city), powerless and destitute
- He sought shelter with a local miller, who killed him in his sleep for his few remaining valuables
- The last emperor of the Sasanian dynasty was given a quiet burial by a Christian bishop in a frontier town, with no kingdom, no army, and no dignified end The Sassanid Empire, which had resisted Rome for centuries, effectively ceased to exist under Hz Usman's caliphate

Egypt: Recovery of Alexandria

- Hz Amr ibn Al as ^{RA} was governor of Egypt at the start of Hz Usman's caliphate
- In the second year: the Romans in Constantinople urged their brethren in Alexandria to break peace with the Muslims, and they agreed
- A huge Roman army marched on Alexandria coming from the sea, Hz Amr met them and defeated them, pursuing them into Alexandria and destroying the city wall.
- Hz Uthman ^{RA} later replaced Hz Amr ^{RA} with **Hz Abdullāh ibn Sad ibn Abi Sarh** ^{RA}, who was given dual responsibility over taxation and the army after the two disagreed
- Under Hz Abdullah bin Saad ^{RA}, the conquest of North Africa was launched

Conquest of North Africa - From Egypt to the Atlantic

- **Hz Abdullah ibn Saad** ^{RA} dispatched to the coastal regions from Tripoli to Tangier
- King Jurjir ruled this kingdom on behalf of the Romans, from Tripoli to Tangier
- Hz Usman ^{RA} sent Hz Abdullah ibn Az-Zubayr ^{RA} with reinforcements; he advised splitting the army into two shifts to tire the polytheists
- Hz Abdullah ibn Az-Zubayr ^{RA} personally killed Jurir, breaking the enemy's resolve
- Peace deal: 2.5 million dinars, one fifth sent to Hz Usman ^{RA}; Ibn Saad spent a year and three months in North Africa
- Hz Usman ^{RA} appointed a new governor of Africa and left Ibn Saad in charge of Egypt

Conquest of Cyprus (28 AH) - The First Muslim Naval Campaign

- Cyprus: one of the largest Mediterranean islands, part of the Byzantine Empire
- Hz Muawiyah ^{RA} had requested both Hz Umar ^{RA} and Hz Usman ^{RA} for permission for naval campaigns
- Hz Umar ^{RA} refused, fearing for Muslim lives at sea
- Hz Usman ^{RA} approved, but made it voluntary for soldiers to participate
- The city of Acre (currently in Israel) was given the order to build ships for the Muslim fleet
- 28 AH: Hz Muawiyah ^{RA} conquered Cyprus with senior Companions including Hz Abu Dharr ^{RA}, Hz Ubadah ibn as-Samit ^{RA}, and Hz Umm Haram ^{RA}
- Peace terms: 7,000 dinars annually to Muslims, equal to Byzantines; Cyprus would inform Muslims of Roman attack plans
- Hz Muawiyah ^{RA} appointed Abdullāh ibn Qays to lead ongoing naval campaigns, he waged fifty battles without a single man drowning

Umm Haram: A Prophecy Fulfilled

- The Prophet ^{SAW} used to visit Umm Haram^{RA} regularly, she would prepare food for him
- He ^{SAW} once fell asleep at her house and woke up smiling
- She asked: "What makes you smile, O Messenger of Allah?"
- He^{SAW} said: "I was made to see some people from my community waging jihad in the cause of Allah, riding on the high seas, they were kings sitting on thrones"
- She said: "Pray for me to be amongst them"
- He ^{SAW} said: You are among them
- He then slept again, and again woke up smiling, was asked the same question and he answered the same way. When Umme Haram requested to pray that she be one of them, he said You are already in the first group.
- When they reached Cyprus, she mounted her riding animal, it threw her, breaking her neck, and she died as a martyr

The Official Manuscript of the Quran

- **The Problem**

- After massive conquests, hundreds of thousands of non-Arabs embraced Islam
- Hz Hudhayfah ibn Al-Yaman ^{RA} noticed alarming differences in Quranic recitation across regions during the campaigns in Tabaristān, Syrians, Kufis and Basris each recited differently due to variations in the Arabic script
- He reported to Hz Usman: "Catch this community before they differ about the Book the way the Jews and Christians differed"

- **The Solution:**

- Hz Uthman ^{RA} obtained the original Mushaf compiled during Hz Abu Bakr's era, kept with Hz Hafsah ^{RA}
- He commissioned Hz Zayd ibn Thabit ^{RA}, assisted by Hz Abdullah ibn Az-Zubayr ^{RA}, Hz Saed Ibn Al as ^{RA}, and others to make multiple copies
- **All other manuscripts ordered to be burnt and destroyed throughout the state**

Extension of Masjid-e-Nabwi

- Masjid-e-Nabwi was too small for the rapidly growing Muslim population
- Hz Usman^{RA} began buying up plots adjacent to the mosque at fair market value, and most residents agreed and sold willingly. However a small number of holdouts refused to sell regardless of the price offered, not necessarily out of malice but perhaps attachment to their homes or simply stubbornness.
- Hz Uthman^{RA} would not force anyone off their property, construction was stalled for approximately four years
- Hz Usman^{RA} delivered a powerful lecture after Jumuah and the people agreed to donate their places
- Construction then proceeded and the mosque was significantly enlarged, with Hz Usman personally funding much of it from his own wealth.

Understanding the Era

- Hz Usman's caliphate marked the end of the first glorious decade of Islam, and the beginning of **a new and turbulent era**
- Almost thirty years had passed since the Hijrah, **a new generation had risen**, lower in faith, weaker in Islamic creed
- This decline coincided with **unprecedented expansion**, wealth, and blessing
- The changes happening were simply **too swift, too much, too fast**. These are the "growing pains" of an empire: peoples who were under Roman or Sassanid rule now giving allegiance to a new religion, a new civilization. Arabs who had been very poor now had wealth pouring in. People who had lived without law now had strict Islamic code to follow
- Pre-Islamic tribal pride also played a role. The Prophet ^{SAW} said: *"Four things from Jahiliyyah, my ummah will never completely rid itself of"* the first is tribalism. Much of the criticism of Hz Usman ^{RA} was rooted in resentment of the Quraysh, specifically the Banu Umayyah.
- The Messenger of Allah ^{SAW} had warned of such tribulations, and they were destined to come to pass

Why Did This Happen? The Root Causes

Six Types of People Who Fuelled the Sedition

1. Those religiously excessive who exaggerated minor issues while committing major sins
2. Those from Yemen with a fanatical racial hatred towards the Quraysh, resentful over war booty
3. Those who felt wronged when Islamic penal law was applied to their relatives
4. Fickle people who followed Ibn Saba' into corruption and heresy
5. Those who coveted leadership and authority they didn't deserve
6. Those reprimanded by Hz Usman for wrongdoing, who harboured grudges

"The mercy and kind-heartedness which dominated Usman's heart eventually inspired greed against him, and they took advantage of his mercy to fulfil their desires." Al-ʿAwāsīm min Al-Qawāsīm

The Prophetic Predictions

The Prophet ^{SAW} predicted the trials in many authentic ahadith:

- "Fitna will come like the waves of the ocean, trial after trial enveloping all of you"
- "A time will come when the one who sits in his house and breaks his sword will be the best person"
- "Allah will test you in this world by internal fighting so that in the next world you shall be forgiven, my ummah is an ummah that is shown mercy in the next life. All of its trials are in this life"
- "Once the sword is unsheathed, it will never be put back" meaning once civil war begins, the ummah will never be fully united
- He pointed to the east (al-mashriq, the lands of Iraq and the newly conquered territories) and said: "The trials will come from there, that is where the horns of Shaytan emerge"

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The real grievances of the rebels came down to two things: **money and power**. They wanted a share of the wealth and the authority. The eleven complaints were the pretext, not the cause

Every complaint had a kernel of truth, then twisted, misinterpreted, and spread. When a person has a diseased heart, they can take the best of actions and read evil into them.

Contributing Factor: Hz Abu Dharr ^{RA} Controversy

- Hz Abu Dharr Al-Ghifari ^{RA} advocated equal distribution of state wealth among all Muslims
- He would stand in the Syria calling out: “O you wealthy people! See to the needs of the poor!” citing Surah At-Tawbah (9:34)
- Hz Muawiyah ^{RA} opposed this. Hz Usman’s position: “My task is to advise people to be moderate in spending, not to impose an ascetic lifestyle”
- His ideas drew massive poor-class support, creating dangerous class tension
- After many complaints Hz Usman RA called him to live in Medina
- After many complaints in Medina he was given the option to either live in the city or live at Ar-Tabadhah, a stopping point on trade route.
- Hz Abu Dharr ^{RA} left for Ar-Rabadhah where he died (32 AH), but left behind a charged social atmosphere
- The rebels twisted this story and said that he was forced out
- The idea of fair wealth distribution was noble in origin, but became weaponised by agitators

The Spearhead of Sedition: Abdullah Ibn Saba

- A Jewish man from the tribe of Himyar; called Ibn as-Sawad (son of blackness) after his enslaved mother
- Appeared to embrace Islam during Hz Usman's caliphate, but his conversion was dubious
- His mission combined two destructive beliefs:
 - **Wisiyyah:** Hz Ali ^{RA} was the Prophet's rightful successor; Hz Usman ^{RA} seized the caliphate
 - **Raj'ah:** Prophet Muhammad ^{SAW} will return, just as Hz Isa ^{AS} will descend
- *His slogan: "Uthman illegitimately seized it (the caliphate), you should revolt, starting by laying accusations against your leaders"*
- He attacked Hz Abu Bakr ^{RA} and Hz Umar ^{RA} though Hz Ali ^{RA} himself dissociated from Ibn Saba and called him a liar
- Dr. Yasir Qazi notes academic caution about Ibn Saba's direct role in the assassination itself. The Sunni tradition is clear that he existed and spread destructive ideas. However, many Sunni scholars note that the actual killing of Hz Usman ^{RA} predates what can be firmly attributed to him, and that the birth of Shi'ism came from multiple factors, not one person alone. What is not in doubt is that his ideology of *Wisiyyah* and *Raj'ah* planted the seeds for later sectarian division

Ibn Saba's City-by-City Campaign

- Basrah: Expelled by governor
- Kufah: Expelled by governor
- Syria: Hz Muawiyah's firm governance left no fertile ground
- **Egypt: Found the most receptive environment**
 - Governor Abdullah Ibn Abi Sarh was preoccupied fighting Romans and Nubians
 - Harsh tax collection had already stirred public resentment
 - Here Ibn Sab'a settled and systematically incited the public against the Caliph
- By 34 AH: a network of covert communication operated across all provinces, criticizing the Caliph and his governors
- A person in Egypt would receive a letter claiming the Muslims of Kufa were being oppressed. A person in Kufa would receive one about Egypt. This created a **false impression of a widespread, cross-empire crisis** when in reality the discontent was manufactured and amplified by a small, organised network. People naturally assumed that if the same complaints were coming from multiple cities, the problem must be real.

Hz Usman ^{RA} Responds with Investigation

- Hz Usman summoned governors during Hajj (34 AH) and consulted them
- Hz Saed ibn Al-As: “This was all secretly fabricated”
Hz Mu‘awiyah: “Bring the persons who spread it and kill them”
- *‘Uthmān chose leniency: “We will repulse it with tolerance and lenience, unless it concerns the injunctions of Allah”*
- **He sent four great Companions as investigators:**
 - Hz Usamah ibn Zayd ^{RA} → Basrah
 - Hz Muhammad ibn Maslamah ^{RA} → Kufah
 - Hz Abdullah ibn Umar ^{RA} → Syria
 - Hz Ammar ibn Yasir ^{RA} → Egypt (drawn to the agitators’ side; did not return)
- First three: “We learnt of nothing but good from your governors”
- Hz Usman ^{RA} invited all those wronged to come to Makkah during Hajj (34 AH) to present complaints, not a single person stayed to file one

The Eleven Complaints

1. Burning of the Muṣḥafs

The rebels accused Hz Usman ^{RA} of burning copies of the Qur'ān and keeping one official version for himself, claiming he had no right to destroy what people had memorized and written in their own hands.

Rebuttal: This was the greatest service to the Qur'ān, different regions were reciting differently, threatening the unity of Allah's Book. Even those who oppose Hz Usman ^{RA} to this day recite from his standardized script; there is not a single Muslim on earth who does not.

2. Exiling Abu Dharr Al-Ghifārī

They claimed Hz Usman ^{RA} had unjustly banished the beloved companion Hz Abu Dharr ^{RA} from Madenah to the remote outpost of Ar-Rabadhah, treating him harshly for simply speaking the truth about wealth distribution.

Rebuttal: Hz Usman ^{RA} just suggested this and did not force him. Hz Abu Dharr ^{RA} himself chose to leave Madenah; Hz Usman honoured him with a dignified send-off of more than twenty camels and two servants.

The Eleven Complaints

3. He Did Not Participate at Badr

New converts with no connection to the Prophet ^{SAW} accused Hz Usman ^{RA} of lacking the right to lead because he was not present at the Battle of Badr, the most honoured military expedition in Islamic history.

Rebuttal: *Hz Usman ^{RA} was absent because the Prophet ^{SAW} sent him to nurse his ill wife Ruqayyah, the Prophet's own daughter. The Prophet ^{SAW} gave Hz Usman ^{RA} a full share of the Badr booty and counted him among the Badris, the highest proof of his status.*

4. He Fled at the Battle of Uḥud

They accused Hz Usman ^{RA} of cowardice, pointing to his withdrawal during the chaos of Uḥud when the Muslim lines broke, using this to undermine his moral authority as Khalifah.

Rebuttal: Allah Himself addressed this in the Qur'ān: "And Allah has already forgiven them" (Al Imran: 155). Who are these rebels, who never saw the Prophet ^{SAW} to reproach someone whom Allah Himself has publicly forgiven?

The Eleven Complaints

5. He Was Not at Bay‘at al-Riḍwān

They claimed Hz Usman ^{RA} missed the Pledge of Ridwan, the sacred oath of allegiance under the tree at Ḥudaybiyyah, which they used to question his commitment and loyalty to the Prophet ^{SAW}

Rebuttal: *The Bay‘ah was held specifically to demand the release of Hz Usman ^{RA}, who had been sent by the Prophet as his envoy to Makkah. The Prophet ^{SAW} placed his own left hand in his own right saying: "This is on behalf of Usman" making Hz Usman ^{RA's} pledge the most honoured of all.*

6. He Seized Public Grazing Land (Al-Hima)

They accused Hz Usman ^{RA} of privatizing public pasturelands outside Madeenah, preventing ordinary Muslims from grazing their animals there, claiming he was enriching himself at the community's expense.

Rebuttal: *The practice of reserving land for state animals was begun by Hz Umar ^{RA} himself. Hz Usman ^{RA} simply expanded it as the state's herds grew, the land was for the camels of Ṣadaqah and Jihād, and he personally owned only two camels for Ḥajj and Jihad.*

The Eleven Complaints

7. He Prayed Four Rakat in Mina

They accused Hz Usman ^{RA} of innovating in worship by praying the full four rakat during Hajj in Mina, when the Prophet ^{SAW} Hz Abu Bakr ^{RA}, and Hz Umar ^{RA} had all shortened it to two as travellers.

Rebuttal: *Hz Usman ^{RA} exercised his own Ijtihad, considering himself a resident rather than a traveller because he had family and property in Makkah, the scholars have different opinions on his ijtiḥad.*

8. He Mistreated Hz Ammar ibn Yasir ^{RA}

They accused Hz Usman ^{RA} of having the great companion Hz Ammar ibn Yasir ^{RA}, whose parents were the first martyrs of Islam, beaten by his guards when Hz Ammar ^{RA} came to present legitimate complaints.

Rebuttal: *The guards acted entirely without Hz Usman ^{RA}'s knowledge or approval. When informed, Hz Usman condemned it immediately and offered his own back for Qisas if Hz Ammar wished. Crucially, Hz Ammar ^{RA} himself later stood in the mosque defending Hz Usman during the siege, criticizing the rebels for cutting off his water.*

The Eleven Complaints

9. He Gave 4% of Egypt's Booty to His Relative

They accused Hz Usman ^{RA} of nepotism by awarding his foster-brother Abdullah ibn Saad one-fifth of one-fifth (4%) of all the war booty from the conquest of North Africa.

Rebuttal: This was the Khalifa's own legitimate personal share of the booty as defined by the Qur'ān. Rather than keeping it, Hz Usman ^{RA} gave it to the commander as an incentive to win the war, a decision that worked; North Africa became Muslim land because of it.

10. He Practiced Nepotism in Appointments

The most famous accusation: that Hz Usman ^{RA} systematically appointed Banu Umayyah relatives to governorships across the Islamic world, blocking others from positions of power and preferring blood over merit.

Rebuttal: Next Slide

The Eleven Complaints

Rebuttal of Nepotism:

- There is a kernel of truth: some of Hz Usman's relatives received positions and financial gifts
- But a simple reading of Hz Usman's actual list of appointees shows: Ansar, non-Arabs, non-Qurayshi, non-Umayyad Qurayshi, and yes, some Banu Umayyah. It was not a monopoly
- Hz Abu Bakr ^{RA} was Banu Taym; Hz Umar ^{RA} was Banu Adi, both tiny sub-tribes with almost no one to appoint. Banu Umayyah was simply the largest sub-tribe of the Quraysh, statistically there were more of them to draw from
- Ibn Taymiyyah in Minhāj al-Sunnah: Banu Umayyah were the most experienced in siyasa, so appointing them was a merit-based decision, not favouritism
- Hz Usman ^{RA} himself said: "My love for my family did not cause me to do zulm unto others. I gave them responsibilities and held them to account, the same as any other appointment"
- The Prophet ^{SAW} himself preferred the Quraysh; that is not zulm, it is wisdom and trust

The Eleven Complaints

11. He Gave Personal Wealth to His Relatives

They accused Hz Usman ^{RA} of directing large amounts of the Islamic treasury to his family members, specifically mentioning sums given to Marwan and others, framing it as theft from the Muslim public

Rebuttal: Every dirham he gave his family came from his own personal wealth earned through trade, not a single coin from the treasury. Hz Usman ^{RA} said: "I who was generous with my own money throughout the lifetimes of Abu Bakr and Umar, now you blame me for giving charity to my own family when I am close to death?"

Hz Muawiyah's Warning

- Hz Muawiyah ^{RA} stood before the senior Companions and delivered a pointed warning: a rumour had spread that they had something against Usman; if the masses got involved, the situation would spiral beyond control
- He offered Hz Usman ^{RA} the chance to come to Syria for his safety, Hz Usman ^{RA} refused, preferring to remain near the grave of the Prophet ^{SAW}
- He also offered to send Syrian soldiers to defend him, Hz Usman ^{RA} rejected this, fearing they would disturb the people of Madinah
- These were the two offers that, had Hz Usman ^{RA} accepted, might have averted the tragedy, he refused both out of noble character

Rebels coming to Medina

- Rebels wrote to troublemakers in Kufah, Basrah, and Egypt: “Come to us, we are going to start the jihad”
- They picked Shawwal to come out, disguising themselves as pilgrims
- ~500 Egyptians under Al-Ghafiqi ibn Harb; similar numbers from Kufah and Basrah
- Hidden agenda: remove governors, force the Caliph to resign, or kill him
- **They secretly disagreed on the successor**, Egyptians wanted Hz Ali ^{RA}, Basrites wanted Hz Talhah ibn Ubaydillāh ^{RA}, Kufans wanted Hz Az-Zubayr ibn Al-Awwam ^{RA}
- All three groups reached Madinah. They arrived and camped on the outskirts, not entering the city proper initially. Their arrival caused immediate alarm among the companions and the general population of Madinah.
- Hz Ali, Hz Talhah, and Hz Zubayr ^{RA} all rejected the rebels’ offers
- The rebels presented their grievances publicly and demanded changes. Hz Uthman (R.A.) responded with remarkable patience.
- He came out and addressed them publicly from the minbar, acknowledged that some mistakes had been made in his administration, promised reforms and the removal of governors they complained about
- The three groups agreed to disperse and return home.

The Forged Letter - The Incident That Ignited the Siege

- Hz Usman ^{RA} agreed to the Egyptians' demand: replaced their governor with Muḥammad ibn Abi Bakr
- The Egyptians were returning home, then spotted a fast-riding servant of Hz Usman ^{RA}
- They arrested and searched him, found a letter bearing Hz Usman ^{RA}'s seal, ordering the governor of Egypt to kill all delegates on arrival
- Hz Usman ^{RA}'s response: "By Allah, I did not write it, I did not dictate it, and I have no knowledge of it." Hz Ali ^{RA} and senior Companions confirmed: "Usman has spoken the truth."
- He suggested the seal was forged; they demanded his scribe Marwan, he refused to expose him to danger
- *Historical note: Scholars (including Al-Awasim min Al-Qawasim) state the letter was almost certainly a fabrication, its entire purpose was to provide a pretext for the siege and the killing*

The Forged Letter - The Incident That Ignited the Siege

- **Arguments in favor of the theory that the letter was forged by the Rebels**
 - Why was a secret royal messenger found prancing around on horseback within sight of the rebel camp, 150 miles from Madeenah, rather than on a direct route to Egypt?
 - He confessed immediately upon capture, not the behaviour of a genuine secret messenger
 - He was left completely unharmed by people willing to kill the Khalafah himself
- The three theories summarized:
 1. The letter was genuine, only non-Sunni groups accept this;
 2. Marwan forged it out of overzealous loyalty, the mainstream medieval Sunni view
 3. The rebels forged it themselves, the view of a number of modern critical scholars

The Siege - Madeenah Under the Control of Insurgents (35 AH)

- The siege lasted approximately 20-40 days, Madeenah was thrown into chaos
- Their three demands: (1) Resign; (2) Hand yourself over for Qisas for the alleged murder attempt; (3) We will fight you to the death
- The rebels barred water from reaching Hz Usman's house; Hz Ali ^{RA} confronted them, they replied: "By Allah, we will not give him a drop"
- Umm Habibah bint Abi Sufyān ^{RA} tried to bring water on her donkey, the rebels struck the donkey, she nearly fell
- Hz Usman's motto throughout the entire siege, repeated again and again: **"I shall not be the first person after the Prophet ^{SAW} to shed the blood of a Muslim."** He commanded Companions physically armed and ready to fight to *stand down*. He invoked his authority as Khalifah over them: *"By the authority Allah has given me over you, go back to your homes and do not hurt the people outside"*

The Siege - Madeenah Under the Control of Insurgents (35 AH)

- Multiple senior Companions begged him to let them fight: Abdullāh ibn az-Zubayr; al-Mughirah ibn Shu'bah who said "You have the numbers, the truth is on your side, give us the command"; al-Ḥarith ibn al-Nu'mān. All were turned away
- A proposal was made to smuggle him secretly to Makkah. Hz Usman refused, it was not fitting for him to flee
- During the siege, Hz Abdullah ibn az-Zubayr was appointed to manage the affairs of the Ummah; ibn Abbās was appointed to lead the Ḥajj that year, because Hz Usman^{RA} could not leave.
- Hz Hasan^{RA}, Hz Husayn^{RA}, Hz Abdullah ibn Az-Zubayr^{RA}, and Hz Muhammad ibn Talhah^{RA} came to protect the Caliph, some were wounded; Al-Ḥasan ibn 'Alī was carried out on a stretcher bleeding from an altercation
- Hz Usman^{RA} appeared from his house and said: *"By Allah, don't you know I purchased the Well of Rumah with my own wealth so that its sweet water may be consumed? Why then are you stopping me from drinking it?"*

Hz Abdullah Ibne Umar's Council

- During the siege, Hz Usman^R asked ibn Umar^{RA} what he should do
- Ibn Umar^{RA} said: "If you were to resign, will you live forever in this dunya?" Hz Usman: "No." He said: "And if you don't resign and they kill you, can they do more than kill you?" Hz Usman: "No." He said: "Do they control your Jannah and Nar?" Hz Usman^{RA}: "No, Allah does."
- Ibn Umar^{RA} concluded: "Then do not take off the shirt that Allah placed on you. If you cave in to them, you will set the precedent that any mob can overthrow any Khalifah by threats. Chaos will reign for every future generation"

Hz Usman's Letter to the Ummah

A Statement of Innocence and Faith

- *“I was nominated by the council of consultants (Shura) without my request. I followed the Prophet's Tradition and not my own whims. But to my surprise, I was attacked and condemned without offending. I have never approved of anything that the Qur'an rejects...”*
- *“I am writing this letter while these people have prevented me from praying in the mosque and seized whatever they could in Madeenah. They are asking me to choose: take reprisals from every person I punished, resign, or let them instruct the armies to abandon obedience to me...”*
- *“So fear Allah and seek the reward that is with Him. I would hate to establish an evil precedent, split the Muslim community and shed blood. I therefore ask you in the name of Allah and Islam...”*
- Ibn Abbas^{RA} read this letter to the people on the 8th of Dhul-Hijjah

The Martyrdom

Friday, 18th Dhul-Hijjah, 35 AH (17 June, 656 CE)

- The rebels burnt down the door and rushed upon Hz Usman RA while he was reciting the Glorious Qur'an silently, while fasting
- He said: "The Messenger of Allah ^{SAW} took a promise from me and I remain firm upon it"
- Muhammad ibn Abi Bakr entered, but did not harm him (he repented shortly before)
- The first person to physically strike was Ruman al-Yamani, who raised a long stick and brought it down opening the door for the others
- Hz Usman ^{RA} at age 82 was wearing no armor, carrying no weapon. He put his hand up to protect himself and his hand was cut off
- He said, even as his hand was severed: "Woe to you, that was the first hand that wrote down the Qur'an."
- Al-Ghafiqi ibn Harb struck Hz Usman ^{RA} with an axe; another insurgent struck him with a sword
- Hz Usman ^{RA}'s wife Nailah rushed to protect him, the sword chopped off her fingers
- One of the insurgents dealt the fatal blow
- **His blood fell upon the open Mushaf, reportedly staining the verse: "But Allah will spare you their evil. For He is the All-Hearing, All-Knowing." (Al-Baqarah: 137)**
- The insurgents robbed the Caliph's house and the Bayt ul-Mal; burial was only allowed at night, with few mourners

The Man Who Gave Everything

A Final Portrait

- Spent his personal wealth to purchase Paradise, the Well of Rumah and the Army of Ushrah (Expedition of Tabūk)
- Gave two daughters to the Prophet ^{SAW} in marriage, Dhun-Noorayn
- Compiled the Qur'ān into one standardized Muṣḥaf for all of humanity for all of time
- Expanded the Prophet's Mosque ^{SAW} at his own expense
- Never sought the caliphate, yet was chosen by the greatest Companions of the Prophet ^{SAW}
- Refused to flee, refused to fight, refused to abdicate
- Met his Lord while reciting His Book, while fasting, in the sanctified city of Madeenah